



The role of involvement: Investigating the effect of brand's social media pages on consumer purchase intention

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ABSTRACT

This study examined the influence of consumer's brand familiarity and the information quality of social media content on their involvement with a brand on the brand's social media pages. Also studied were the influence of involvement on consumer's attitude towards the brand's social media page and the effect of their attitude on future purchase intention from the brand. The results indicated that both brand familiarity and information quality had significant effects on a consumer's involvement with a brand on its social media page, yet the brand's social media content had a greater influence on a consumer's involvement with the social media page. Further, involvement with a brand's social media led to a positive attitude towards the brand's social media page, which in turn influences future purchase intention from the brand. However, the involvement did not directly influence future purchase intention from the brand. The results suggest the significant importance of quality of social media content.

1. Introduction

Trending Twitter hashtags, "Like Us" on Facebook, "Viral Videos" on YouTube, and "Pin Boards" on Pinterest – social media is a phenomenon that is hard to miss. According to a study done by Smith (2016), as of July 2015, more than 70 percent of Internet users are active social media users, having an average of 5.54 social media accounts. There are many reasons that individuals may engage in social media – for entertainment, connection points, or mindless searching activities. Social media has seen steady growth due to the ease of connecting as well as the option to choose whom to connect with, when to connect, and what to share (Kumar and Sundaram, 2012). To date, with almost 100% dispersion of mobile phones worldwide (ICT, 2014), social media are even more accessed and used at all times and places.

Users of social media are not limited to only individual people, as social media can act as a platform for an organization, a business, a cause, or a brand. These other entities can make use of social media to create content and reach out to others – meeting at the social media connection points. It can often be confounding for a business or brand to grasp how they might influence and engage in conversations with their customers. These conversations usually take place over a wide range of platforms and vast communities as well as at different rates of time (i.e., rapid vs. over many months). In 2015, social networks earned an

approximately more than \$8 billion from advertising and 38% of organizations plan to spend more than 20% of their advertising budgets on social media channels in the same year, rising 13% up from a year ago (Smith, 2016). In addition, today 91% of retail brands currently use two or more social media channels (Smith, 2016).

Social media is a tool that can be harnessed by brands and retailers to engage and influence their customers. Mersey et al. (2010) noted that social media provide an opportunity for businesses to participate and interact with potential consumers, encourage an increased sense of intimacy with consumers, and build relationships with potential consumers. Colliander and Dahlen (2011) investigated the power of blogs on brand attitude and intention and noted the importance of relationship building and transparency in blogs and other forms of social media. Customer engagement within Facebook has been examined to determine enhancing satisfaction and loyalty, yet the authors note that more research should be done within other online communities (Gummerus et al., 2012). Hudson et al. (2016) suggest that when the brand interacts with followers on the social media page by replying to comments, solving problems, and inviting participation, consumers have stronger relationships with the brand having a feeling of connection and thus experiencing a higher level of relationship quality. Social media is a low-cost, easy to use, platform offering a direct link for a brand to its consumers. It is essential to understand the factors influencing

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consumers to engage with a brand on social media platforms and the effects of involvement on social media.

As the landscape of communication is changing, it becomes vital for brands to understand how involvement on social media platforms may influence consumer's attitudes and intention. Past research has focused primarily on the Facebook community, yet social media is a broad realm with many brands and consumers being active on multiple sites (Duru-kan et al., 2012; Gummerus et al., 2012; Yang, 2012). In this study, we look at social media as an entire entity to gauge involvement, attitude, and intention. The purpose of this study is to examine the influence of consumers' brand familiarity and information quality of social media content on their involvement with a brand on social media pages. This study also examined the influence of consumers' involvement on social media pages on consumer's attitude towards the brand's social media pages and future purchase intention from the brand. This study further examines the effect of consumers' attitude towards the brand's social media presence on future purchase intention from the brand.

2. Theoretical framework

The Associative Network Theories of Memory (ANT) explains brand familiarity and their influence on perceptions and patronage behavior with the brand. Existing evidence from the research supported the impact of familiarity of a brand on perception and patronage of the brand (Collins-Dodd and Lindley, 2003; Flavian et al., 2006; Keller, 1993; Kim et al., 2008a,b; Romaniuk and Sharp, 2003). In this vein, our primary objective was to examine whether this notion applies to the environment of social media. This study, further, attempted to discover whether information quality of the social media page can account for a significant increment in determining the effect on involvement with a brand's social media pages above and beyond that being explained by brand familiarity. Besides, derived from the Theory of Reasoned Action (Ajzen, 1985, 1991), this study examined the relationship between attitude toward social media pages and future purchase intention from the brand in the context of the social media environment.

3. Literature review

3.1. Involvement with brand on social media

Involvement, particularly consumer's involvement with a brand on social media, is a significant relationship to understand. Yang (2012) defined involvement as, "the perception of the correlation of participation ... based on internal needs, values, and interests" (p. 52).

For this study, involvement will refer to the participation with a brand in the realm of that brand's social media pages driven by needs, values, or interests and in particular brand familiarity (Huang et al., 2010). Research has found that the leading indicators of involvement are personal factors (i.e., prior use of social media), stimulus factors, and situational factors (i.e., brand familiarity) (Zaichkowsky, 1986). Previous studies have found that involvement influences factors such as brand attitudes, purchase intention, advertising attitudes, and online shopping behaviors (Bosnjak et al., 2007; Huang et al., 2010; Yang, 2012). For instance, Bosnjak et al. (2007) studied online purchase intention and found that affective involvement was a significant indicator of online purchase intention. Huang et al. (2010) investigating travel blogger's involvement found that high involvement bloggers had a more positive opinion towards advertisements and posit this as a significant indicator of purchase intention when managing brands.

In 2008, Kim, Choi, and Han studied the role of online community commitment in raising brand commitment and found a significant influence of online community commitment on brand commitment. They found that online community participants possess stronger brand commitment than consumers who are not members of the community. Interestingly their results revealed that among online community members, brand commitment is enhanced for both active brand users

and non-users of the targeted brand. Casalo et al. (2008) also found that participation in a virtual community has a positive influence on consumer commitment to the brand. In a study of social media communication and its impact on purchase intention, Wang et al. (2012) found that consumption-related communication on social media is positively related to their attitude toward the product. Additionally, this communication informs consumers' decisions regarding purchasing and increased involvement with products (Wang et al., 2012). Jahn and Kunz (2012) studied how fan pages affect the customer-brand relationship and what motivates to participate. They found both fan-page usage and engagement, as indicators for involvement with the brand, significantly influencing brand loyalty. Hutter et al. (2013) analyzed the impact of brands' social media activities and consumers' involvement with the social media pages of the brands on the purchase decision making process. They found that social media involvement significantly influenced all three decision making stages: the cognitive phase (awareness and knowledge), the affective stage (liking, preference, and conviction), and the conative stage (purchase and loyalty). They also noted that the degree of involvement with social media applications is an important indicator of positive WOM and purchase intention from the brand. Furthermore, Hajli (2013) supported the findings of other researchers in that the interconnectivity of individuals through social media create trust in e-commerce, which eventually leads to purchase behavior from the company. Laroche et al. (2013) reported that they found social media based brand community has a strong impact on customer relationships and brand loyalty. Kang et al. (2014) tested the influence of consumers' participation in the brand's social media (Facebook) pages on brand trust and brand commitment. Their study affirmed that active participation in a brand's social media page enhances both brand trust and brand commitment; thus, strengthening consumer-brand relationships. In addition, Kang et al. (2014) found brand trust plays a mediating role in the relationship between consumers' active participation in a brand's social media pages and brand commitment. More recently, in a study of the effect of social media communication on consumer perceptions of brands, Schivinski, and Dabrowski (2016) found that both user-generated and firm-created social media communications significantly affect consumers' brand attitude. A study done by Kamboj and Rahman (2016) revealed that social media-based brand community members' active participation significantly influences brand commitment and brand loyalty. Accordingly, the following hypotheses have been developed:

H1. Consumers' involvement with a brand on social media will influence their attitude towards a brand's social media presence.

H2. Consumers' involvement with a brand on social media will influence their future purchase intention from the brand.

The Theory of Reasoned Action (TRA) (Ajzen, 1985, 1991) posits that attitude toward an object and subjective norm are direct determinants of intention to perform a behavior. Attitude toward an object is renowned as a person's positive or negative evaluation of an object and is comprised of a person's salient beliefs. In Gefen et al., 2003, and Straub reported that trusting beliefs has a significant impact on online purchase intention. Other researchers also found that trust can have an indirect impact on online purchase intention (McKnight and Choudhury, 2006; Wen et al., 2012). In Glasman and Albarracín (2006) found that attitudes correlated with future behavior more strongly when they were easy to recall (accessible) and stable over time. According to their findings, attitudes more strongly predicted future behavior when people have increased direct experience with the attitude object. In addition, they also reported that the attitude-behavior association was strongest when participants formed their attitude on the basis of behavior-relevant information. Earlier studies indicated that, in the context of online shopping, consumers' attitudes toward a website or online shopping significantly affect their shopping behavior in an online setting (Eri et al. (2011); Javadi et al., 2012; Seock and Norton, 2007). ICT, 2014, See-To and Ho observed that trusting belief of the product on

fans page in social networking sites (SNS) has a positive impact on an SNS user's purchase intention of the product. Kang et al. (2014) confirmed a significant relationship between brand trust formed through active participation in a brand's social media pages and brand commitment. A more recent study done by Schivinski and Dabrowski (2016) also revealed that consumers' brand attitudes formed from their communications in a brand's social media pages have a significant and positive influence on purchase intention from the brand. Thus, we attempt to examine the relationship between attitude and future purchase intention in the context of social media and develop the following hypothesis.

H3. Consumers' attitude towards a brand's social media presence will influence future purchase intention from the brand.

3.2. Brand familiarity

Alba and Hutchinson (1987) noted that brand familiarity serves as an essential source of information about a brand, which is enhanced by accumulated experiences within a brand or frequent exposure to the brand. Consumers tend to consider a brand as familiar when the brand is frequently advertised in the media. Thus a well-known brand is more familiar to consumers and easier to recall and recognize than an unknown brand (Kent and Allen, 1994). In Campbell and Keller (2003) noted that brand familiarity refers to the degree of a consumer's direct and indirect experience with a brand. Brand familiarity examines a consumer's brand knowledge structure and leads to processing behavior. Familiar and unfamiliar brands are stored differently in a consumer's memory. Familiar brands fall into a category where consumers have had prior experience with a brand, frequent exposure through the brand's advertising, or when consumers may know individuals who have recommended the brand.

Previous research posits that well-established brand names serve as a powerful cue that influence purchase decisions (Maheswaran et al., 1992). Earlier studies suggested that consumers often use brand name or related cues as a basis for product choice (Adaval, 2003; Brady et al., 2008) and brand familiarity plays a crucial role in consumers' perceptions towards brand or products, and in purchase intentions from the brand (Gefen, 2000; Laroche et al., 1996). A study done by Doong et al. (2011) indicated that enhancing brand familiarity leads to consumer's offline brand loyalty and higher shopping intentions. Fen et al. (2012) explored the effects of perceived risks, quality, and familiarity of store brands and found brand familiarity had the strongest overall influence on the perceived quality and purchase intention of store brand items. Seock and MacBride (2012) also found that consumers' knowledge and familiarity with a brand is a major determinant in shaping their perceptions of and preferences for the brand, thus suggesting the more consumers know about a brand and the more familiar they are with the brand, the more positively consumers view them. The aforementioned earlier studies suggest that when consumers are more frequently exposed to a brand, whether through actual usage, advertising, or promotional efforts through various media, they may view the brand more positively and develop preference over other brands. Srivastava and Kamdar (2009) investigated the link of the brand image and brand familiarity with involvement finding that brand familiarity is more salient for high versus low involvement among consumers.

Complexity in an online environment may cause purchase avoidance; however, familiarity with a brand may increase customers' participation in the brand's social media community seeking information from both the company and users. Previous studies in the context of online shopping show that brand unfamiliarity is a greater disadvantage online than offline especially with products that need sensory experience (Degeratu et al., 2000; Danaher et al., 2003; Saini and Lynch, 2016). On the contrary, Simonson (2015) speculated that brands matter less online than offline because the Internet provides superior information about quality to offline shopping via online reviews. Van Der

Heide and Lim (2015) suggested that users who are familiar with a social media platform are more likely to rely on user-generated contents for their online purchases than those who are unfamiliar. In keeping with numerous precedents about brand familiarity as being a prominent factor in the consumer decision-making process, we speculated that brand familiarity might lead to brand involvement within the realm of social media. Thus, the following research hypothesis is developed.

H4. Consumer's brand familiarity will influence their involvement with a brand on social media.

3.3. Information quality of social media content

Earlier studies revealed that consumer's commitment to an online store is highly related to information on the website (Park and Kim 2003, 2006). In 2010, Jones and Kim found that the information quality of the website significantly influences online shopping intention from the website. Previous research has examined information quality and credibility in Internet discussion forums. Savolainen (2011) states, "The issues of information quality and credibility are gaining importance, particularly in the World Wide Web context. The WWW provides a unique information seeking environment, but often lacks quality control mechanisms." (p. 1243). Savolainen also suggested that future research should investigate information quality in other Internet platforms aside from discussion forums and how this information quality may impact the use of other online platforms. Social media is a platform for the exchange of content between individuals; thus there must be a level of quality from that content to enhance consumer involvement with the brand on social media. In a study done by Yang (2012) investigating decision behaviours on Facebook, it was found that as individuals were exposed to messages containing a higher level of utilitarian and recreational values, the factors of involvement, advertising attitude, brand attitudes, and purchase intention increased. Researchers also agreed that a feeling of social media based brand community positively influence consumers' involvement in that brand's social media page (Christodoulides et al., 2012; Habibi et al., 2014). More recently, Chung and Muk (2017) found that consumers' attitude toward messages on social media is strongly correlated to interactivity and information on the social media page. They also suggest that active interaction and useful information on social media pages produce positive perceptions of the company's social media page, which leads to their impulsive shopping behavior from the company. Based on prior studies, we suggest that information quality on the brand page of social media might have an incremental effect over brand familiarity on consumer involvement with a brands social media page. Thus, we developed the following hypothesis:

H5. There will be an incremental effect of information quality of a brand's social media content over brand familiarity in determining the effect on consumer's involvement with a brand on social media.

Fig. 1 shows the proposed model with research hypotheses.

4. Research method

4.1. Participants

Data were collected from 159 US college students at a large south-eastern university using a structured questionnaire. The population for this research is representative of female college students age 18 to 25. A convenience sample of female undergraduates was invited in their classes to participate in the survey. This specific sample is appropriate for the study as 67% of all Internet users are said to be active on social networking sites, and of these, 83% are between the ages of 18 and 29 with 71% being women (Duggan and Brenner, 2013; Brenner, 2013). Based on VanVoorhis and Morgan (2007) the sample size (N = 159) was appropriate for the data analysis method used in the study.



Fig. 1. Proposed Research Model. Note: Dotted line indicates incremental effects of information quality over brand familiarity on involvement on brand's social media pages.

4.2. Measures

The questionnaire began by asking the participants about their prior experience of using social media to screen out individuals who did not have any experiences using social media. Participants were then asked to list the top three social media sites they frequented and to identify a brand they had recently interacted with on social media. Participants were instructed to recall the identified brand when answering the remainder of the survey. Survey participants were then asked questions regarding their brand familiarity, perceived quality of the brand's social media content, involvement with the brand on their social media pages, attitude towards a brand's social media presence and future purchase intention from the brand. All scales were measured on a 7-point Likert-types scale (1 – strongly disagree; 7 – strongly agree).

To measure brand familiarity, four items were adapted from Doong et al. (2011), and Ha and Perks (2005). Participants were asked to rank how they agree or disagree with statements such as “I am familiar with this brand,” “I know what this brand stands for,” “I have a clear understanding of the person who would use this brand,” etc. The information quality of brand's social media content was measured with eleven items adapted from Savolainen (2011), which contained adjectives such as useful, specific, valuable, factual, comprehensive, reliable, variety, and so on. Brand involvement on social media was measured with ten items from Huang et al. (2010). The questionnaire contained statements such as “I am actively involved in the brand's social media,” “I spend a lot of time engaging in the brand's social media,” “I enjoy interacting with other members on the brand's social media,” etc. Attitude towards the brand's social media presence was measured with five items adapted from Huang et al. (2010). The questions included in the scale were “I like this brand's social media,” “I think this brand's social media sites are reliable,” “I think this brand's social media sites are valuable,” etc. Purchase intention was measured with three items from Hu et al. (2011), which included “In the future, I am very likely to purchase from this brand,” “I expect I will purchase from this brand in the future,” “I intend to purchase this brand in the future.” Demographic items such as age, race, and college standing were collected. Questionnaire items can be found in the Appendix. To ensure clarity of survey items and statements the questionnaire was pre-tested and corrections were made as appropriate.

5. Results

Data gathered from the survey was analyzed using the Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS) program. The data analysis consisted of descriptive statistics, exploratory factor analysis, and hierarchical regression analysis and bivariate regression analysis. Cronbach's alpha values were computed to assess the internal consistency aspect of reliability of the multi-item scales measuring brand familiarity (0.72), information quality (0.93), Involvement (0.92), Attitude (0.94) and further purchase intention (0.97) (see Table 1). The respective alpha values for all the variables included in the study deemed sufficiently reliable for use. In preparation for testing hypotheses, scores for brand familiarity, involvement toward social media, attitude and patronage

Table 1

Cronbach's alpha, means and standard deviations for all variables.

	Cronbach's alpha	Mean	Standard Deviation
Brand familiarity	0.72	6.24	0.83
Information quality	0.93	5.67	0.97
Involvement	0.92	2.93	1.28
Attitude	0.94	5.89	1.08
Purchase intention	0.97	6.41	1.08

intentions were computed by summing the items in each scale. The means and standard deviations for all variables were also calculated as shown in Table 1.

A principle component of factor analysis with varimax rotation was conducted to identify the constructs of information quality of social media. To set the criteria for the factor analysis, factors with eigenvalues greater than 1.0 and items with rotated factor loadings of 0.50 or greater were used. With the total 11 items, only one construct was identified, and a total of 60.67% variance was explained by this one factor. Thus, a summated score for information quality items was used in the analysis.

5.1. Hypothesis testing

Bivariate regression analyses were implemented to examine the relationship between social media involvement and attitude towards social media presence (H1) and future purchase intention (H2) and the relationship between attitude towards social media presence and future purchase intention (H3). The regression model for the relationship between involvement with brands through social media and attitude towards brands' social media presence (H1) was significant, with $F(1, 156) = 26.77, p < .001$, indicating that 14.6% of the variance in attitude towards a brand's social media presence was explained by involvement with a brand on social media (see Table 2). However, the regression model for the relationship between involvement with brands through social media and future purchase intention from the brands (H2) was not significant, with $F(1, 158) = 2.11, p > .05$ (see Table 2). The regression results for hypothesis 1 and 2 are reported in Table 2.

The regression model for the relationship between attitudes toward brands' social media presence and future purchase intention (H3) was significant, with $F(1, 158) = 32.36, p < .001$, indicating that 17% of the variance in future purchase intention from the brands was explained by attitude towards brands' social media presence (see Table 3). Given the

Table 2

Bivariate regression analyses for H1 and H2.

	Attitude		Purchase Intention	
	B (SE)	β	B (SE)	β
Involvement	.16 (.031)	.38***	.03 (.020)	.12
R ²	.146		.01	
F	26.77***		2.11	

Note: Independent variable is involvement and dependent variables are attitude (H1) and purchase intention (H2);*** $p < .001$.

results from H1, H2 and H3, a Sobel's test was conducted to examine the power of the indirect effect of involvement on social media pages on future purchase intention from the brand, as being mediated by attitude toward the brand's social media page, and found a significant mediation in the model ($z = 3.84, p < .001$). The regression analysis result for hypothesis 3 is reported in Table 3.

To assess the impacts of brand familiarity and information quality of social media pages on consumers' involvement (H4 and H5), a hierarchical regression analysis using the enter method was conducted. Derived from the Associative Network Theories of Memory and the previous literature, brand familiarity was first entered into the regression equation in hierarchical regression analysis (H4), and then information quality was entered into the equation (H5). In this way, the correlations between brand familiarity and information quality variable were partialled out of the regression analyses, allowing the researcher to examine a significant incremental increase in R^2 after controlling the effect of brand familiarity on the dependent variable, social media involvement. Thus, we can understand how much additional variance in social media involvement can be explained by information quality. In this analysis, brand familiarity and information quality were independent variables, and social media involvement was the dependent variable. The hierarchical regression analysis results for hypothesis 4 and 5 are reported in Table 4.

The regression model (model 1 for H4) was significant, with $F(1, 157) = 15.39$ and $p < .001$, indicating that 8.9% of the variance in the involvement with a brand on social media was explained only by brand familiarity. H4 was supported. Then information quality of social media pages was entered into the regression equation to determine its incremental effect over brand familiarity on involvement with a brand on social media (H5). The overall regression model (model 2 for H5) was significant, with $F(2, 156) = 11.62$ and $p < .001$, indicating that 13% of the variance in the involvement with a brand on social media was explained by both brand familiarity and information quality of the social media page. In this hierarchical regression model, significant F change was $p = .000$, suggesting significant incremental effects of information quality over consumer brand familiarity in determining the effect on social media involvement. Thus, Hypothesis 5 was supported. When testing the relative contributions of independent variables to explain consumers' involvement with a brand on social media, information quality of social media pages ($\beta = 0.235, p < .01$) was the stronger indicator of the social media involvement than brand familiarity, although both variables had the significant influence on social media involvement.

6. Discussion and conclusions

The results of our study displayed the antecedents and outcomes of involvement on social media from the perspective of the Associative Network Theories of Memory (ANT) and the theory of reasoned action framework and provided valuable insights about involvement on social media. The findings offer meaningful implications for interactive marketing practitioners, online advisers, and social media website operators. Besides, the contribution of our findings to consumer behavior literature in academia is that involvement on social media is becoming increasingly relevant in consumer shopping and purchase behavior and can significantly influence newcomers' attitude toward the company or

Table 4

Hierarchical regression analyses for H4 and H5.

Variables	Social Media Involvement	
	Model 1 (β)	Model 2 (β)
Brand Familiarity	.299***	.128*
Information Quality		.235**
R^2	.089	.130
R^2 Change	0.089	0.040*
F	15.39***	11.62***

Note: Independent variables are brand familiarity and information quality and dependent variable is involvement; * $p < .05$; ** $p < .01$; *** $p < .001$.

brand.

In this study, we found that both brand familiarity and information quality of a brand's social media content did significantly influence consumers' involvement with the brand's social media pages, while information quality had a greater impact on social media involvement than brand familiarity. Also, the results showed that an individual's involvement with that brand on social media is a significant factor in forming and facilitating attitude towards the brand's social media pages, which eventually leads to future purchase intention. Interestingly, this study revealed that familiarity with a brand had less impact than information quality on being involved with the brand's social media pages. These findings suggest an opportunity for brands to gain potential followers and eventual customers by targeting those who are not familiar with their brand. By presenting quality information through the social media content to individuals unfamiliar with the brand this may facilitate consumers' involvement with the brand's social media pages. This finding aligns with a study by Mersey et al. (2010) in that social media provides an opportunity for companies to engage and interact with potential customers and build relationships with them.

For this study, respondents were asked to recall a brand they interacted with on a social media platform. This brand recall inherently establishes a sense of familiarity with the brand, since the respondents were required to remember a brand they had recently interacted with on social media. Our findings suggest that brand familiarity may initially prompt an individual to seek out the brand's social media pages. Thus, while familiarity may attract an individual to a brand's social media page, the information quality of the brand's social media content plays a more significant role in enhancing consumers' involvement to the company's social media page. Our finding is consistent with the prior studies which have found connections between information quality and involvement (Yang, 2012; Zaichowsky, 1986). Our study suggests that if customers find social media content relevant, important, and notable, then they may be more willing to get involved with the brand's social media pages. Those interested in or familiar with a brand may find themselves on a brand's social media pages, but it is a matter of quality of the content which will influence their involvement with the brand's social media pages. This also implies that new customers, individuals unfamiliar with the brand, and even those outside of the brand's expected target market may be prompted to become involved with the brand on its social media pages just by the quality of content the brand crafts for social media.

Further, it was found that involvement with a brand's social media page significantly influences the attitude towards the brand's social media. This relationship follows from other studies which have established the relationship between involvement and attitude (Bosnjak et al., 2007; Huang et al., 2010; Kang et al., 2014; Schivinski and Dabrowski, 2016; Yang, 2012; Zaichowsky, 1986). Unlike previous research (Jones and Kim, 2010; Kang et al., 2014; Schivinski and Dabrowski, 2016), the result of our study indicated that involvement with a brand's social media does not directly influence future purchase intention from the brand. Although involvement did not directly lead to future purchase intention, the result of the mediation test showed that it has a significant indirect effect on future purchase intention from the brand, as mediated

Table 3

Bivariate regression analysis for H3. Note: Independent variable is Attitude and dependent variable is purchase intention; *** $p < .001$.

	Purchase Intention	
	B (SE)	β
Attitude	.247 (.043)	.412***
R^2	.170	
F	32.36***	

by the attitude toward the brand's social media, supporting a mediating effect of brand trust (attitude) between social media participation and brand commitment revealed in Kang et al. (2014) study. That is, consumers' active social media involvement drives their future purchase intention from the brand through attitude toward the company's social media pages. Our finding implies that companies' active interactions with the people through a brand's social media pages will bring a strong trust and commitment toward the brand. This also supports previous literature that states that social media community involvement has a significant effect on the purchase decision-making process and customer relationship management (Hajli, 2013; Hutter et al., 2013; Laroche et al., 2013). Also, our study shows that attitude towards the brand's social media pages influences future purchase intention from the brand.

From the results of the study, we suggest that companies should be particularly concerned with the content on their social media pages as this leads to greater involvement on the social media pages, which could influence future purchase intention. As companies are in control of the content they publish on their social media pages managers should understand what type of information people want to obtain from their social media page, and further need to know how consumers want to interact with the company and other people through the social media pages. Social media managers who oversee information flow on their branded social media pages should use analytics software to track items most viewed, liked, re-shared, or otherwise notable to their users. From this, brands can determine the points of information their users find of the highest quality. They should then leverage this content to encourage higher involvement on their social media pages, potentially through promotions, product specifics, or pulling content from their users to facilitate a reciprocal connection between brand and user. Besides, providing feedback through various social media platforms could be essential in making social media a viable communication channel for customer relationship management.

As social media creates a platform for brands to reach out to their customers, it is increasingly of interest how the brands might influence their customers through this medium. This study indicates that of utmost importance is the quality of social media content on the brand's social media pages. Brands are always interested in more likes or shares on Facebook and followers on Twitter and Instagram. To establish this type of involvement is it necessary for the brand to use the content published on their social media pages to facilitate this involvement from customers and general followers. While users may be hesitant to engage on a brand's social media pages and instead remain an observer, brands should encourage comfortable and natural engagement with their users by providing useful and interesting information that has variety. Examples include: posing a question that facilitates a conversation with users, giving fun facts about the brand, re-posting users comments to

build a greater rapport with the brand. Brands can also leverage their social media pages by providing value-added content to their users through how-to videos, tutorials, or contests. Social media managers may, in turn, see more followers on their social media platforms or a spike in involvement on their social media pages. Based on the findings of this study, brands should be poised to offer directives towards selling channels as this involvement may impact future purchase intention. It would be important for these social media pages to include web links with more details about how and where to purchase or be ready to answer users' questions about making future purchases from the brand.

6.1. Limitations and future research

The findings of this study were significant and add to the body of knowledge about involvement and the brand's social media pages, but it is not without limitations. First, the demographics and location of participants in the study limit the generalizability. Future studies could expand the target audience and consider various age ranges as it is no longer just millennials who are active users of social media platforms. Further analysis among other demographic characteristics and social media behaviors should be considered in future studies. Additionally, this study was limited by the respondent's recall in identifying a brand they had recently interacted with on social media. While a necessary prompt to establish a threshold of familiarity as respondents completed the questionnaire, future studies should consider a focus on particular brands or product categories. In a social media context, the information features of the pages are identified to be a crucial factor in determining consumers' page involvement and decision-making in terms of whether or not they will shop the brand. This emphasizes the importance of information quality and user interface design in the social media page development, such as emotional and aesthetic elements of the page design. Thus future research should investigate what specific content or information on a brand's social media pages do consumers find favorable and noteworthy. It can be a balancing act as to how much information consumers want on social media pages. Thus other studies should determine not only the type of information consumer's view as quality content but also the frequency and invasiveness of this information. Future studies could also investigate relationship-oriented interactive communication through social media and its influence on perceptions and transaction activities for the brand.

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Appendix A. Supplementary data

Supplementary data to this article can be found online at <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2019.101975>.

Appendix

Construct	Operational Definition	Reference
Brand familiarity • I have heard of this brand before • I have made a purchase from this brand • I know what this brand stands for • I am familiar with this brand • I have a clear understanding of the person who would use this brand	Customer's set of knowledge based on experience with a brand	Doong et al. (2011); Ha and Perks (2005).
Information quality <i>I find the quality of content on the brand's social media site to be:</i> • Useful	Customer's positive or negative evaluation of informational content presented on a brand's social media	Savolainen (2011)

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Construct	Operational Definition	Reference
• Correct • Specific • Objective • Valuable • Factual • Comprehensive • Interesting • Reliable • Official • Good Variety		
Involvement on brand's social media	Customer's participation with a brand's social media driven by personal needs, values, and interests	Huang et al. (2010)
• I frequently interact with other members of this brand's social media sites • I have an interactive communication with other members of this brand's social media sites • I cooperate with other members of this brand's social media sites • I am actively involved in the brand's social media sites • I spend a lot of time engaging in the brand's social media sites • I provide feedback related to participation in the brand's social media sites		
Attitude toward brand's social media	Customer's perception of the brand's social media	Huang et al. (2010)
• I like this brand's social media sites • I think this brand's social media sites are reliable • I think this brand's social media sites are friendly • I think this brand's social media sites are valuable • I think this brand's social media sites are of good quality		
Future purchase intention	Customer's intention to make a purchase from the brand	Hu et al. (2011)
• In the future, I am very likely to purchase from this brand • I expect I will purchase this brand in the future • I intend to purchase this brand in the future		

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